

Savings Tracker Spreadsheet Documentation

Overview

The Savings Tracker is a comprehensive, automated spreadsheet designed to help you monitor financial goals, track account balances, and log deposits or withdrawals. This tool provides a clear visual representation of your financial progress and simplifies the math behind reaching your targets.

Note: This spreadsheet and its documentation were optimized with assistance from Google Gemini.

1. Key Features

- **Multi-Goal Tracking:** Monitor up to five distinct savings goals simultaneously (e.g., Emergency Fund, Vacation, Home).
- **Multi-Account Management:** Track balances across multiple accounts or wallets (e.g., AMEX, Apple).
- **Automated Progress Metrics:** Instantly view the percentage completed, remaining amounts, and monthly targets needed to hit your deadlines.
- **Visual Dashboard:** Features a stacked bar chart and in-cell progress bars for quick visual health checks of your finances.
- **One-Click Automations:** Built-in macro buttons for logging allocations and reallocating funds between goals effortlessly.

2. Spreadsheet Sections & Data Representation

A. Savings Goal Tracker (The Dashboard)

This is the primary dashboard where your goals live. The table below outlines the core components:

Component	Description
Goal Name & Target Amount	The name of the objective and the total

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	financial amount needed.
Saved So Far & Remaining	Automated calculations showing current dedicated funds and the remaining balance.
Progress Indicators	Includes a % Complete metric and an in-cell visual bar chart (sparkline) that fills as you near the goal.
Time Metrics	Displays the Target Date, Months Left, and a calculated Monthly Target to stay on track.
Accomplished Checkbox	A manual toggle used to mark a goal as fully funded.

B. Account Summary

This section monitors the actual locations where your money is stored, ensuring a "zero-based" budgeting approach.

- **Previous & Current Balance:** Tracks the starting balance and the live, updated balance based on logged transactions.
- **Status & Money Left to Allocate:** Ensures every dollar is accounted for and strictly assigned to a specific goal.

C. Transaction Log

This log acts as the central engine of the spreadsheet. All Dashboard and Account Summary calculations pull directly from here.

- **Log Details:** Records the Date, Goal, Description, Account, Amount, and Transaction Type (Deposit or Withdrawal).

D. Visual Charts

Savings Allocation by Account and Goal: A stacked column chart that visually breaks down asset distribution. It illustrates exactly how much money in each account is dedicated to specific goals in an easy-to-read format.

3. How Calculations Work (The Automations)

The spreadsheet utilizes automated formulas to seamlessly maintain data accuracy:

Metric	Calculation Method
Saved So Far	Utilizes a SUMIFS formula to total all "Deposits" and subtract "Withdrawals" associated with a specific Goal Name.
Current Balance (Accounts)	Adjusts the "Previous Balance" by adding the sum of all transactions linked to that specific Account Name.
Monthly Target	Subtracts "Saved So Far" from the "Target Amount", and divides the result by "Months Left" to provide a dynamic monthly quota.
Cross-Referencing Matrix	A hidden background matrix calculates the proportion of each account's balance belonging to specific goals, which powers the visual charts.

4. Extensions and Scripts Used

To make data entry highly efficient, the tracker employs Google Apps Script (Macros) attached to interactive sheet buttons:

- Log Allocation Button:** A scripted macro that captures data from the staging area and automatically logs it as a new, permanent line item within the Transaction Log.

- **Log Reallocation Button:** A script designed to seamlessly move funds between goals or accounts. It automatically generates the necessary withdrawal and deposit line items to ensure balanced records.

5. Step-by-Step Guide: How to Use the Tracker

1. **Setting Up a New Goal:** Type the desired objective into the Goal Name column. Input the Target Amount and Target Date. The sheet instantly computes your required monthly target.
2. **Updating Account Balances:** Enter the starting funds in the Previous Balance column within the Account Summary section.
3. **Logging a Transaction:** When adding or spending money, create a new row in the Transaction Log. Specify the Date, applicable Goal, Account, Amount, and Transaction Type (Deposit/Withdrawal). The dashboard reflects these changes instantly.
4. **Reallocating Funds:** To shift money between goals (e.g., from "Vacation" to "Emergency Fund"), use the Reallocation tool and press the Log Reallocation button. This records the transfer safely without disrupting underlying calculations.